

While the book is filled with fantastic photographs, it isn't just a celebration of the beauty of our natural world. It reveals the geology—and sometimes physics, chemistry, botany, and zoology—behind different features. Even the most complicated processes are explained in simple terms. And incredibly detailed artworks, constructed from satellite terrain data and imagery, reveal aspects of the natural wonders that cannot be seen with the naked eye. By viewing from above, going underneath, and looking inside, the artworks explain major geological formations and the processes behind them, including rift valleys, river canyons, island arcs, and stratovolcanoes.

This book doesn't just focus on geological wonders—the key animals and plants that live in, on, or around the different features are included, and the world's most important forests and grasslands are given their own entries. And if you want to know how a supercell storm forms, then turn to the section on extreme weather. In all, more than 240 of Earth's natural wonders are covered in detail and a further 230 are described in the directory. But rather than reading from cover to cover, this is a book that you will pick up, put down, and then return to time and time again as you try to decide where next in the world you wish to travel to.

